EUonAIR / RESILIENT FUTURES LAB

Would you take this job?

A student job offer, a free trial and a confident AI reply



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OPENING CASE

Marta has until seven to decide

Marta, 18, is looking for evening work. A stranger sends her a message.

17:30 FIRST MESSAGE

“I hire for Linden Market. Rate five product photos and we’ll pay you 100 UAH.”

18:00 THE 100 UAH ARRIVES

“Want the next set? Send a 600 UAH deposit by seven. You’ll get it back.”

ON YOUR OWN
1 MIN

What would you do next? Write one reason. Keep your answer for the end.

UAH is the currency code for the Ukrainian hryvnia.

A DOCUMENTED CASE IN UKRAINE

A task scam in the Zhytomyr region

A woman told police she signed up to post likes and comments. To get better-paid tasks, she had to send her own money.

After the second transfer, the supposed employer stopped replying.

MONEY SHE REPORTED SENDING

98,000

UAH, approximately



About 50,000

Another 48,000

Zhytomyr regional police, Korosten district report, 15 January 2024. One applicant’s account.

THE JOB OFFER

Which money can Marta actually spend?

MARTA'S RECORDS	
Starting bank balance	**1,000 UAH**
Trial payment in her bank app	**+100 UAH**
Deposit the sender wants	**600 UAH**

RECRUITER'S WEBSITE

1,600 UAH

The site calls this her "pending earnings".

IN PAIRS
2 MIN

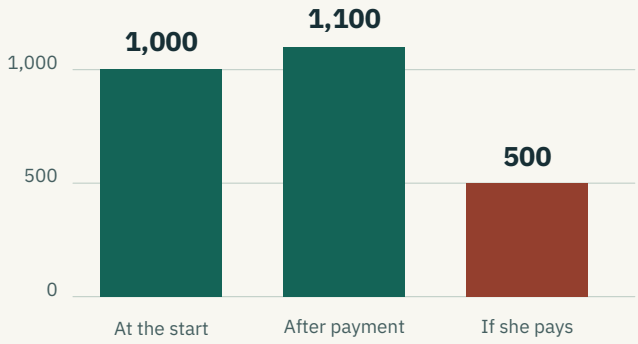
If she pays, how much stays in her bank account? Which figure did you leave out?

The Ukrainian Cyber Police describe how small early payments draw people in.

THE MONEY

Marta would have 500 UAH left

BANK BALANCE IN UAH



A small first payment can build trust.

The deadline gives Marta little time to check. Her bank app shows what moved. The recruiter controls the figure on the website.

Classroom calculation. The US Federal Trade Commission documents this use of fictitious earnings.

Can Marta trust this reply?

She asks about the deposit and leaves out her name and bank details.

SCRIPTED AI REPLY FOR DISCUSSION

“Linden Market refunds deposits. The first payment proves the sender works for them.”



In pairs, 2 min. Pick out two claims. What evidence would you want for each one?

THE EVIDENCE

What can each source establish?

The AI says the company refunds deposits and employs the sender.

A	**Marta’s bank app**	“Incoming transfer. 100 UAH.”
B	**Recruiter’s screenshot**	“We refund all reviewer deposits.”
C	**Hiring office by phone Number from its website**	“Applying here is free. We have no openings for product reviewers.”

IN PAIRS 4 MIN

Which source settles the fee question? What does the bank entry prove?

MARTA'S DECISION

The hiring office settles the fee question

HOW MARTA CHECKS THE OFFER



Marta keeps the 600 UAH. The hiring office confirms that applying is free. Her bank confirms the payment. The sender's identity is still unknown.

A QUESTION THE AI CAN HELP WITH

"What should I ask the hiring office about a recruiter who wants a deposit?"

She can use the draft questions. Names, ID photos and bank details stay out of the chat.

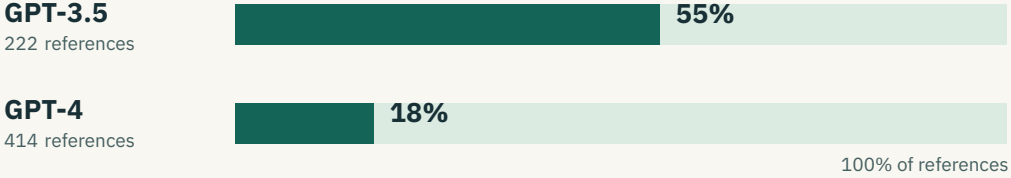
Employer checks and advance fees. Ukrainian Cyber Police, guidance on fraudulent job offers.

A PUBLISHED EXPERIMENT

An AI assistant can invent a reference

In 2023, two researchers checked 636 references in 84 short literature reviews written by two AI models.

SHARE OF REFERENCES THAT THE MODEL INVENTED



When an AI cites a policy, open the original and find the sentence that supports its answer.

W. H. Walters and E. I. Wilder, Scientific Reports, 2023, Table 3. The results describe these models and this task.

THE NEXT APPLICATION

What would a free CV trial cost?

Marta finds a CV service. Her job-search budget is 600 UAH.

FIRST SEVEN DAYS

0 UAH

RENEWAL TERMS

The first charge is 150 UAH on day 8. The service charges the same amount every 30 days until she cancels.

IN PAIRS
2 MIN

What is left after three charges? Which day is her last chance to cancel for free?

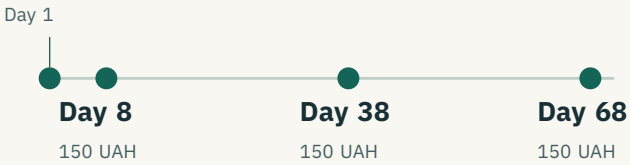
Fictional prices and terms. US Federal Trade Commission, guidance on free trials and automatic renewals.

THE SUBSCRIPTION

Three renewals would cost 450 UAH

Marta would have 150 UAH left for the rest of her job search.

BILLING DATES IN THE EXAMPLE



THREE CHARGES

450 UAH

For the free week alone, cancel by the end of day 7. Set a reminder and keep the cancellation confirmation.

Classroom calculation. The example uses a 30-day billing interval.

THREE MORE INTERNET SCAMS

What does the sender want from you?



A parcel text

“Your parcel is on hold. Pay a small delivery fee by card here.”



A call from “the bank”

“Read me the code we just sent. I can stop the payment.”



A part-time job

“Use your account to forward our client payments. Keep a share.”



IN PAIRS
2 MIN

Choose one message. What could the sender gain? Name one place you could check the story.

Messages based on alerts from the US Federal Trade Commission and the Ukrainian Cyber Police.

Where would you go to check?

MESSAGE	WHAT THE SENDER WANTS	A SAFER NEXT STEP
Parcel phishing	Card details entered on a fake delivery page.	Open the courier’s own app and check your order there.
Fake bank call	A one-time code to enter your account or approve a payment.	Keep the code private. End the call and use the number on your card.
Money mule offer	Your account to move money that may be stolen.	Decline the transfer. If money has arrived, contact your bank before moving it.

FTC on parcel messages, FTC on verification codes and Ukrainian Cyber Police on money mules.

What if a friend has already paid?

1. **Call the bank immediately.**
   Use the number on the card or in the bank app. Ask if the bank can stop the transfer and secure the account.
2. **Save the messages and payment record.**
   Keep the sender’s username and the transaction reference for the report.
3. **Report the incident to the Ukrainian Cyber Police.**
   Use the official form at **ticket.cyberpolice.gov.ua**. A friend can sit with you while you do it.

Ukrainian Cyber Police guidance on job fraud and reporting.

FINAL EXERCISE

A friend forwards a museum internship

Your friend has three pieces of information. Read them before you reply.

THE MESSAGE	“Apply through our CV service. Seven days free, then 90 UAH every 30 days.”
THE AI REPLY	“The museum requires this service for all interns.”
MUSEUM CAREERS PAGE	You open the museum’s site yourself. It says, “Email your CV to our hiring office. Applications are free.”

ON YOUR OWN
3 MIN

Write a text to your friend. Name the source you trust, give the cost of two renewals and say how to apply.

CLOSING DISCUSSION

What would you text your friend?

ONE POSSIBLE REPLY

> **“I checked the museum’s own careers page. You can email them your CV for free. Two renewals would cost 180 UAH. I’d apply directly.”**

Look back at your first answer about Marta. Which detail would you check first now?

:-)

SOURCES

Evidence and further reading

UKRAINIAN POLICE REPORTS AND GUIDANCE

Korosten district case, January 2024

How task scams use early payments

Advance fees and fake job offers

Money mule recruitment

Ukrainian Cyber Police reporting form

RESEARCH ON AI REFERENCES

Walters and Wilder (2023), Table 3. *Scientific Reports*, 13, 14045.

US FEDERAL TRADE COMMISSION

Free trials and automatic renewals

Text scams and fake delivery fees

Why someone asks for a verification code

How task scams create fake earnings